

Chapter 2: Typing Skills

Class 5 – Keyboard Layout Review, Home Row Keys & Finger Placement

Learning Objectives

After completing this lesson, students will be able to:

- Identify the different sections of a computer keyboard.
 - Understand the importance of the keyboard in typing.
 - Recognize different types of keyboard keys.
 - Identify the Home Row Keys.
 - Demonstrate correct finger placement on the keyboard.
 - Follow proper typing posture and keyboard handling techniques.
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Introduction

A **keyboard** is one of the most important **input devices** used to enter letters, numbers, symbols, and commands into a computer. Learning the correct keyboard layout and finger placement helps students type faster, more accurately, and comfortably.

Good typing habits improve speed, reduce mistakes, and make computer work easier.

What is a Keyboard?

A **keyboard** is an input device used to type information into a computer.

Uses of a Keyboard

- Typing letters and numbers
- Writing documents
- Entering commands
- Searching information
- Playing educational games
- Creating projects

Keyboard Layout

A standard keyboard is divided into different sections.

Main Sections of a Keyboard

- Alphabet Keys
- Number Keys
- Function Keys
- Navigation Keys
- Numeric Keypad
- Special Keys

Alphabet Keys

Alphabet keys contain the letters **A to Z**.

Uses

- Typing words
- Writing sentences
- Creating documents

Number Keys

Number keys contain the numbers **0–9**.

Uses

- Entering numbers
- Performing calculations
- Typing dates and phone numbers

Function Keys

The function keys are labeled **F1 to F12**.

Uses

- Performing special commands
 - Opening help menus
 - Refreshing web pages
 - Running shortcuts in software
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Navigation Keys

Navigation keys help move the cursor around the screen.

Examples

- Arrow Keys
 - Home
 - End
 - Page Up
 - Page Down
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Numeric Keypad

The numeric keypad is located on the right side of most keyboards.

Uses

- Fast number entry
 - Calculations
 - Data entry
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Special Keys

Some important special keys include:

- Spacebar
- Enter

- Backspace
- Shift
- Caps Lock
- Tab
- Ctrl
- Alt
- Esc
- Delete

Functions

Key	Function
Spacebar	Inserts a space between words
Enter	Moves to the next line or confirms a command
Backspace	Deletes characters to the left
Shift	Types capital letters and special symbols
Caps Lock	Types all letters in uppercase
Tab	Moves to the next field or indentation
Esc	Cancels the current action
Delete	Deletes selected text or items

Home Row Keys

The **Home Row Keys** are the keys where our fingers rest while typing.

Home Row Keys

Left Hand: A – S – D – F

Right Hand: J – K – L – ;

These keys help us type efficiently without looking at the keyboard.

Correct Finger Placement

Each finger has a specific position on the keyboard.

Left Hand

Finger	Key
Little Finger	A
Ring Finger	S
Middle Finger	D
Index Finger	F

Right Hand

Finger	Key
Index Finger	J
Middle Finger	K
Ring Finger	L
Little Finger	;

Thumb

- Spacebar

Typing Posture

Good posture helps prevent tiredness and improves typing speed.

Correct Typing Posture

- Sit upright with your back straight.
- Keep both feet flat on the floor.
- Keep your shoulders relaxed.
- Bend your elbows comfortably.
- Place your wrists slightly above the keyboard.
- Look at the monitor while typing.
- Keep both hands on the Home Row Keys.

Basic Typing Rules

- Use the correct finger for each key.
- Do not hit the keys too hard.
- Type slowly and accurately.
- Look at the screen instead of the keyboard.

- Keep both hands on the keyboard.
 - Practice regularly to improve speed.
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Home Row Practice

Students practice typing:

- ASDF
 - JKL;
 - ASDF JKL;
 - A S D F J K L ;
 - FJ FJ FJ
 - ASDF ASDF
 - JKL; JKL;
 - ASDF JKL; ASDF JKL;
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Importance of Finger Placement

Correct finger placement helps to:

- Increase typing speed
 - Improve typing accuracy
 - Reduce typing mistakes
 - Build muscle memory
 - Reduce hand fatigue
 - Improve confidence while typing
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Keyboard Care

Students should:

- Keep the keyboard clean.
- Use clean hands before typing.
- Press keys gently.
- Avoid eating or drinking near the keyboard.
- Cover the keyboard when not in use (if applicable).

Did You Know?

- The standard keyboard layout is called **QWERTY**, named after the first six letters on the top row.
- Touch typing means typing without looking at the keyboard.
- Professional typists use all ten fingers to type efficiently.

Points to Remember

- A keyboard is an input device.
- The Home Row Keys are **A, S, D, F, J, K, L, ;**.
- The thumbs rest on the **Spacebar**.
- Good posture improves typing comfort and accuracy.
- Regular practice helps improve typing speed and confidence.
- Always handle the keyboard carefully.